

SC 301

Spring term, Revision Lecture

General Tips

- Make your arguments and answers show that you are interested in these debates!
- Enjoy writing – enjoy making your points
- Jot down the question you are attempting to keep your focus and also making it easier for the marker.
- Read the question very carefully to provide a well argued answer and not a general one.

Foucault

- What has sociology traditionally understood power to be? (Marx, Weber, etc.)
- How is Foucault's position different?
- Think about:
- Discipline and disciplinary power (you need to know this)
- Details such as hierarchical observation.
- Is power repressive or productive?
- What does this mean? Give examples.
- You could use theorists from other lectures such as Butler or you could talk about the lecture on Vision/Perception/Knowledge.
- How are power and knowledge linked?
- Make an argument!

Social Theory, “Race” and Experience

- What does it mean to think “philosophically” about “race”?
- What was the modernity’s relationship with race (scientific racism, ideology, colonialism)
- Du Bois as a neglected founding father of sociology
- He talks about the experience of race.
- And what it feels like to “be a problem” (this is important).
- Experience as double consciousness .
- Ever feeling one’s “twoness”. What does this mean? Don’t just say he is like Mead or Goffman or Cooley. We want to know what Du Bois adds to the argument.
- You need to be able to assess how relevant Du Bois’ ideas are for talking about society today.
- It would help if you used the ideas of Toni Morrison and/or Paul Gilroy to back up your argument but also writers such as Fanon can also be brought into conversation.

Post-Colonial Theory

- What is post-colonial theory?
- Or to put it another way? Why was it necessary, what is it trying to do?
- You should look at the power of ideas or concepts in constructing not just images of the world but how the world is!
- The West as a construction.
- The “West and the Rest”. What does this mean? Don’t just summarise Hall (though you need to know and explain his ideas). Use Said or Fanon or Mohanty to explain Hall’s idea further.
- The West as something which CONSTRUCTED “Others”.
- You can also talk about:
 - Said on Orientalism
 - Fanon on being a subject (and object) of colonialism
 - Mohanty on “third world woman)
- What is at stake in this question? What are the political implications of thoughts and concepts.
- Postcolonial theory critiques European modernity as unjust, unequal and exploitative phenomenon.
- Make an argument. Don’t just copy out what other people say.

Vision and Power

How we see the world depends on power relation,
it doesn't exist in a neutral context

We learn how to see things as appealing or
abhorrent

Our relationship with the world already formed by
frames of seeing and understanding

Haraway and situated knowledge: what is missing
when we see knowledge through a bird's eye
perspective

Vision and power in today's society

The Global South

- What is meant by the term “Southern theory”?
- What does it include?
- Why does it matter?
- How can Southern theory help “Western” theory develop?
- What more needs to be done to make a Southern Theory more robust?

Anthropocene

- The concept
- How does the climate crisis relate to capitalism and modernity?
- Does the northern hemisphere is far more responsible for degradation of the ecosystem?
- How and why?
- COME TO A POSITION/MAKE AN ARGUMENT

Technology and Modernity

Nonwestern perspectives on technology and being
Do they offer something new?

Is Gandhi's view on technology in anyway novel and
fodder for critical reflections?

Having a sense of that the global technological
discourse isn't unilinear and that there are many cultural
and political interpretations that make it more dynamic
than the teleological turn makes it to be.

Multiple Modernities

Is this a useful concept as a way out of European modernity

What does it mean to think of multiple modernities, to add more and more ways of being modern

Does the concept subtract something from our discourses and practices

Reviewing multiple modernities as a heuristic and conceptual tool.